

STDN pitch deck

PITCH — STDN — VERDICT

PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION — minimum starter, gated, 0.40% of book at ~\$13.27; no adds until the authorization and DOE-allocation gates clear.

What we believe

Standard Nuclear turns government-owned enriched uranium into TRISO reactor fuel pellets. It IPO'd on 7/16/2026 at \$15 and trades at **\$13.272** (evidence pack tape; 52-week range \$7.05–\$17.34, so it is down 23.5% from the high but still up 88% from the low).

Our belief, stated plainly:

1. **This is a toll processor, not a fuel company.** The uranium (HALEU) is allotted by the Department of Energy to STDN's *customers* — Radiant and Antares — and STDN gets paid to convert it. That means the celebrated ~67% gross margin is a conversion fee on free raw material, and it means STDN cannot ship if DOE does not allocate to its customers, regardless of whether STDN's plants are authorized to operate.
2. **The funded business is small.** The \$576.9M "backlog" is a through-2035 number in which one metric ton is firm and seven are options. Decomposed, the firm piece is roughly **\$13M a year**. The Q2 revenue of \$4.7M was a single 50-kg shipment to one customer, not a run rate.
3. **The stock is priced for the scale-up, not for the funded case.** At the near-term 2.5 metric-ton throughput the company itself guides to, the whole company is worth roughly **\$4–6/share**. You only get to today's price if you believe the 7.5-tonne world (the two plants plus the Framatome joint venture) arrives, and you only get meaningfully paid above \$20 if you believe the 10-tonne world arrives and is funded without brutal dilution.
4. **Therefore: a small, gated starter, not a position.** We buy a lottery ticket on a real industrial asset with two named customers and a government-blessed feedstock path, sized so that the January share-unlock cliff and a possible stock offering cannot hurt us, and we add only on evidence, not on price.

What the market believes

The market believes the headline. UBS raised its target to \$20 on 9/1 — after the 8/20 customer agreement — and Stifel is at Buy. Those targets sit ~50% above the tape and above the funded value of the company as either of our benches calculated it. The street appears to have taken the \$576.9M backlog and the "93% growth" at face value without splitting firm orders from options, and it appears to be treating "targeted Q4 2026 authorization" as a schedule rather than an aspiration.

The market also believes — reasonably — that the US government wants a domestic TRISO supply chain badly enough to keep feeding it. That belief is not stupid. It is just not underwritten by anything we can observe.

Honest caveat: **we could not retrieve a single consensus revenue number.** Neither bench could. So we cannot say precisely what the street's numbers are, only what its price targets are. A price target is the weakest possible read on consensus, and we say so rather than pretend.

Why we might have edge

- **Backlog decomposition.** We split the \$576.9M into ~\$13M/year of firm revenue plus a nine-year option tail. The street headline number was published undecomposed and the sell-side raise came after it. If that is right, it is a real informational gap and it is *bearish* — which is why our position is small rather than absent.
- **The toll-processing insight.** Recognizing that the 67% margin sits on customer-supplied, government-allocated uranium reframes the whole risk stack: the binding gate is a DOE allocation decision to a third party, not STDN's own plant authorization. We have not seen this framed anywhere in public commentary.
- **The capacity arithmetic is public but scattered.** The 2.5-tonne near-term number, the 2-tonne Framatome JV, and the ~40-tonne end-of-decade ambition live in three different documents. Putting them in one table is not genius, but it is work most holders have not done.

Why it might be priced in

- Everything above is drawn from public filings, public trade press, and a public earnings call. There is no private data here. A careful reader of the 10-Q and the Q2 call can reach the same place.
- The bearish leg (option-inflated backlog, tolled margin) is more likely to be understood by the shorts than by us, and the stock is already 23.5% off its high.
- The bullish leg (40-tonne ambition, government support) is exactly what a \$2B market cap on \$4.7M of quarterly revenue is already paying for. We are not discovering the story; we are arguing about the discount rate on it.
- **Net:** our expected value is roughly **+12%** over ~15 months against a stock that can plausibly halve. That is a starter, not a thesis.

What could go wrong

Failure narrative #1 — DOE quietly reprioritizes the uranium. *No monitorable tripwire.*

DOE allots HALEU to customers using internal prioritization criteria, including material controlled by NNSA. If Radiant's or Antares' allocation is delayed, shrunk, or redirected to a competing reactor developer, STDN has nothing to convert — its plants can be fully authorized and still idle. There is **no public docket, no filing trigger, and no third-party observable** for an allocation decision. Customs data does not help: this uranium is domestic and never crosses a border, so it never appears on

an import manifest. We would learn about it from a revenue miss, one to three quarters late.

Unknown-unknown class: DISCRETIONARY STATE-ALLOCATED INPUT — a business whose principal raw material is distributed by administrative discretion to a third party, with no published register, no appeal record, and no leading indicator. We cannot build a sensor for this. We can only size for it.

Failure narrative #2 — the customers are the cohort. 100% of revenue and essentially all funded backlog is owed by private, pre-revenue microreactor developers who fund themselves by selling equity. If rates back up or the AI-datacenter power trade cools, those two companies raise less, order less, and stretch payables. STDN's receivables *are* the advanced-nuclear cohort; it is not decoupled from it. Partial tripwire exists (funding-round press, an 8-K on any contract modification), but it lags the underlying stress by months.

Failure narrative #3 (the reflexive / structural leg) — the float breaks before the story pays. The IPO floated ~10M shares against ~154–161M total outstanding. Roughly **94% of the shares unlock around mid-January 2027** — before or on top of any authorization payoff. Separately, the charter authorizes 175M Class A shares against ~143M issued: about **32M shares of unissued headroom**, which is a far more likely dilution instrument than the lockup itself, because the 40-tonne plan is entirely unfunded and the remaining scale capex is on the order of \$150M+. A single follow-on into a 10M-share float would be a 3x float expansion. *Our own size vs. liquidity:* we cannot pull ADV in this sandbox. Estimating **0.8–2.5M shares/day** (~\$11–33M notional) from comparable hot small-float industrial IPOs, a 0.40%-of-book starter is a few thousand shares — under 0.5% of a day's volume, immaterial on the way in. **The asymmetry is on the way out:** if the January unlock plus a follow-on triples the float while the story is unresolved, the exit is against a tape where every insider is a seller and we are one of very few natural buyers. Doctrine interaction: our own “add on weakness” rule and the lockup-flush add band point in the same direction at the same time — we would be adding into precisely the supply event most likely to be permanent rather than mechanical. We have hard-separated those two cases in the entry bands below, and any Class A shelf or ATM filing voids the add entirely.

If this position loses money, the most likely reason will be that the uranium never showed up — DOE allocated HALEU to someone else, or slowly, and STDN's authorized plants sat idle while ~94% of the shares unlocked into a 10-million-share float, an outcome for which we have no sensor, no docket, and no lead time.

What we checked ourselves

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Tape price used by the benches	Recomputed against the evidence pack's own fields (px 13.272; dd52 = $13.272/17.34-1 = -23.5\%$; off-low = $13.272/7.05-1 = +88.3\%$)	BOTH BENCHES ERRED. Red litigated the entire case off \$13.98 — 5.3% high — inflating its own “+50% bar” to \$20.97. Blue caught it but then substituted \$13.312 / -23.2%, also wrong. Correct +50% bar is \$19.91	NO — corrected here; all bands below use \$13.272

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Red: “prize ≤ tape, FATAL” at 5.5 MTU	Rebuilt red’s model with blue’s corrected inputs (160.7M shares, ~\$240M pro forma cash, ~\$150M capex, 67% GM, \$50M opex, 21% tax, 15x)	5.5 MTU × \$62k/kgU = \$13.72/share vs. a \$13.27 tape. Red’s conclusion survives its own corrected arithmetic at 5.5 MTU. Red’s headline \$18.79 came only from a 110M share count that its own alternate column already contradicted	PARTLY — right answer, wrong route
Blue: red “OVERTURNED, FATAL→SIZING”	Traced blue’s overturn to its inputs	BLUE OVERSTATED. The overturn rests almost entirely on adding the 2-tonne Framatome JV to reach 7.5 MTU. That JV increment is neither funded nor dated. Cash correction alone moves the roof from \$12.38 to \$13.72 — it does not overturn anything	NO — we re-tag this REDUCED, not overturned
Red’s stated mind-changer: “shares out <100M”	Blue pulled 10-Q Note 8 — 175,000,000 Class A / 35,615,000 Class B / 116,141,488 preferred authorized (primary); ~132.7M A + ~11.6M B pre-offering + 10M IPO ≈ 154M; third-party tally 160.67M	Not <100M. Red’s own reopen condition is refuted. Good bench work by blue	YES (with a 154 vs 161M reconciliation still open)
The evidence pack’s XBRL block (rev / sbc / dil_sh / ocf)	Read directly	EMPTY. Every share-count and cash figure in this deck comes from a narrative filing or a third-party tally, not from audited XBRL. This is a real weakness in both benches’ math	NO
67% gross margin is “scaled economics”	Q2 8-K / call (primary); WNN/ANS on DOE allotment	Margin earned converting DOE-allotted, customer-owned uranium. It is a toll spread. Both benches agree this is the single best finding in the file	YES
“...and the margin inverts if STDN buys uranium”	Looked for pass-through language	No contract clause was ever read by either bench. Blue is right to downgrade this to plausible; blue is also right that if \$62k/kgU is a conversion fee on free feedstock, bundled-fuel revenue per kg would be <i>higher</i> — so red’s price column may be a floor, not a ceiling	NO — plausible only
Backlog \$119.3M funded / \$576.9M total	8-K exhibit + customer PR: minimum one MTU, up to eight, through 2035	1 firm / 7 optional over a 9-year tail ≈ \$13M/yr firm. The “93% growth” is basis mix	YES
“Targeted Q4 2026 authorization” is a schedule	Call operative text; searched for a docket	Aspirational. But red’s “no third-party observable at all” was too strong — blue found DOE approval of the preliminary documented safety analysis for both plants, and NRC approval for Framatome’s Richland facility to make TRISO	PARTLY — red reduced
15x earnings and 21% tax in both prize tables	Inspected the assumption	Neither bench examined either. A pre-scale company with unfunded capex	NO — flagged, not resolved

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
		is not obviously a 15x business, and a company with large loss carryforwards would not pay 21% in the early years. The tables are directionally useful and precisely wrong	
Q2 \$4.7M as a run rate	8-K: \$3.1M product + \$1.6M service, one 50-kg core	One batch, one customer, from the 0.5-tonne pilot line	YES — not a run rate
Consensus FY2027 revenue	Attempted; no connector reachable	Not retrievable by either bench. Red converted the absence into “we agree with the street,” which is not a finding. Blue is right to reject that	NO — genuine gap, item 2 below
Lockup expiry date	Both benches: search budget exhausted	Never verified. Both used ~mid-January 2027 as an inference from a 7/16/2026 IPO	NO — item 1 below
Whether a SCIENCE BRIEF was commissioned	Read the inputs	The SCIENCE BRIEF block is empty. For a fuel-qualification-dependent deep-tech name this is a process gap; no digest section can be written, and the underlying technical question is carried as open item 10	NO

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

All levels off the corrected pack tape of **\$13.272**. Sizing in percent of book; the sleeve cap is hard.

Immediate action — BUY starter: \$13.27, up to \$13.60 limit, 0.40% of book. Basis: expected value \$14.85 vs. \$13.27 (+12%), with a funded-case floor near \$4.50–6.00 and a credible \$18–20 on the 7.5-tonne case. That ratio justifies presence, not weight.

Adds — each requires an evidence gate, not just a price:

Add	Price condition	Evidence gate (all required)	Size
A1	≤ \$11.00	8-K or company PR confirming authorization to operate at both SN-TN and SN-ID	+0.35%
A2	any price ≤ \$16.50	A DOE HALEU allocation naming Antares volumes against the funded metric ton	+0.30%
A3	≤ \$9.50, only in the 10 sessions around the unlock	Lockup date verified from the underwriting agreement, and no gate has failed, and no shelf/ATM on file. This is the mechanical-flush add and it is explicitly <i>not</i> the same trade as A1	+0.20%

Sleeve cap: 1.25% of book. No add above **\$16.56** (the 26-week high) under any circumstance — above that we are paying for the JV increment we just conceded is unfunded.

Trims and exits: - Trim half at **\$19.91–\$20.00** (the +50% bar, and the top of the 7.5-tonne / 15x roof at \$19.85). - Exit the remainder at **≥ \$23.70** (7.5 tonnes at 18x). Above that the price requires the 10-tonne world, which requires capex we have shown is unfunded — i.e. it requires the dilution that kills it. - **Hard stop, thesis (not price): exit in full** on any of — (a) a Class A shelf/S-3/ATM or a follow-on using the ~32M authorized headroom; (b) an 8-K or call disclosing authorization slipping to 2H 2027 or later; (c) any disclosed change, termination, or renegotiation of the Radiant or Antares agreements; (d) a DOE statement reallocating HALEU away from either customer. - **Price stop: \$9.40 close, sell half** — this is discipline, not valuation. Be explicit: the funded 2.5-tonne case is worth \$4–6/share, so there is **no valuation floor above roughly \$6**. Anyone who tells you \$9 is “support” is reading a chart, not a filing.

Catalyst dates: - **2026-11-16** — next earnings print. **UNCONFIRMED:** this is derived from yfinance, not from a company date PR. No company earnings-date release since 8/12/2026. ~46 trading days out; no print-proximity constraint applies today. - **Q4 2026 (undated, placeholder 2026-12-31)** — targeted authorization to operate at SN-TN and SN-ID. Aspirational, no docket, unscheduled. - **~2027-01-12** — estimated 180-day lockup expiry (IPO 7/16/2026). **Date unverified.** A 90-day early-release window would put a follow-on as early as 2026-10-14. - **Undated** — Framatome JV production start at Richland; DOE HALEU allocation decisions.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 9.4 (deck-provisional: sell half on close; discipline stop, not valuation - funded 2.5 MTU case is only 4-6/sh)
- filing watch: 8-K until 2027-03-08 (deck-provisional: authorization to operate at SN-TN and SN-ID - the named binary catalyst, currently unwatched)
- dated pack STDN|2026-11-16: STDN: next earnings print - yfinance-derived, no company date PR since 2026-08-12 (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack STDN|2026-12-31: STDN: placeholder for company-targeted Q4 2026 authorization to operate; aspirational, no DOE docket exists (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack STDN|2027-01-12: STDN: estimated 180-day IPO lockup expiry (IPO 2026-07-16); date never read from the underwriting agreement (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack STDN|2026-10-14: STDN: earliest plausible 90-day early-release / follow-on window (date confirmed=False)

What remains unverified

1. **Lockup expiry date and early-release carve-outs.** Both benches inferred mid-January 2027 and neither read the underwriting agreement. Estimate: **2027-01-12 ±10 days**, with a 15% chance of a 90-day early-release trigger at 2026-10-14, based on the standard 180-day US IPO convention. Draggable now via EDGAR full-text on the S-1 underwriting exhibit.

2. **Consensus FY2027 revenue and its range.** Not retrievable by either bench; the divergence test therefore failed on both sides and neither bench has earned a claim that we disagree with the street. Estimate: **\$35–70M**, built up from ~\$13M/yr firm backlog plus a partial year of 2.5-tonne throughput at \$57–62k/kgU. Not drainable in this sandbox.
3. **Whether DOE will allocate HALEU to Antares against the funded metric ton, and when.** No public register exists. Estimate: **55% within 12 months**, from the base rate of DOE follow-through on already-announced allocation programs to named awardees.
4. **DOE HC-2 authorization-to-operate date for SN-TN and SN-ID.** Estimate: **30% by 2026-12-31, 70% by 2027-06-30**, anchored on the disclosed preliminary-safety-analysis approval already in hand and typical 6–12 month slippage in first-of-a-kind nuclear facility authorizations.
5. **Exact fully-diluted share count.** Blue's build gives ~154M; a third-party tally gives 160.67M; the pack's XBRL dil_sh field is empty. A ~4% discrepancy that moves every per-share number in this deck. Estimate: **154–161M, midpoint 157M**. Drainable now from the 10-Q cover XBRL tag.
6. **Average daily volume and realized float turnover.** Estimate: **0.8–2.5M shares/day** (~\$11–33M), from small-float NYSE industrial IPOs in their first two months. Not drainable in this sandbox.
7. **Whether a listed options chain exists, and its chain-level midpoint implied volatility.** Estimate: **60% likely a chain exists** (NYSE-listed, ~\$2B cap, 8 weeks post-IPO); if it does, **IV 75–100%** based on comparable recent nuclear and small-float IPO names. Not drainable in this sandbox.
8. **Whether the ~67% gross margin survives STDN purchasing its own uranium — i.e. is there a pass-through clause.** No contract exhibit was read. Estimate: **35–50% gross margin on purchased feedstock**, using merchant conversion-services comps; note blue's counterpoint that bundled fuel revenue per kg would also be higher, which partly offsets.
9. **Counterparty funding runway at Radiant and Antares.** Both private and pre-revenue. Estimate: **12–24 months** each, from the base rate for venture-funded hardware developers 12–18 months past their last disclosed round.
10. **TRISO product qualification status — irradiation-test data, fuel-qualification basis, and whether STDN's product is accepted for its customers' specific reactor designs.** **No SCIENCE BRIEF was supplied to either bench**, so no technical claim ledger exists for a name whose entire value rests on a materials-qualification process. Estimate: **partial qualification, 60%** — one 50-kg core has actually shipped and been accepted, which is real evidence, but shipment acceptance is not a full irradiation-qualification basis.

PRIZE TABLE + VOL READ

Prize table (anchor: the two benches' shared model — 67% GM, \$50M opex, 21% tax, 160.7M shares, ~\$240M pro forma cash, ~\$150M remaining scale capex, \$57–62k/kgU realized price; then adjusted for what we found above). Horizon ~15 months.

Scenario	What has to happen	Price	Prob.
Gate failure	DOE allocation withheld or delayed, or a customer stumbles, or authorization slips to 2H27. Market re-prices to the funded 2.5-tonne case plus \$1.49/sh of cash	\$6.00	25%
Base	Authorization lands, 2.5 tonnes runs, JV still undated. Market keeps paying an option premium over the ~\$4–6 funded value	\$14.00	40%
Scale visible	Authorization + a DOE allocation naming Antares volumes + Framatome JV start. Market prices the 7.5-tonne / 15x roof (\$17.99–\$19.85)	\$19.00	25%
Full re-rate	10-tonne path funded without punitive dilution, multiple to 18x (\$29.93–\$32.89)	\$30.00	10%

EV = \$14.85 vs. a \$13.272 tape = **+11.9%**. Table dispersion σ = **\$6.86**, i.e. **46% of EV over 1.25 years $\approx$ 41% annualized**.

Read that honestly: a +12% expected return with a 25% chance of losing more than half is a *starter*, not a position. It is also why the bear scenario, not the bull, drives the sizing.

Vol read — and the arithmetic behind the instrument choice.

No options chain is present in the evidence pack, and no chain-level quote feed was reachable by either bench. So the required IV-vs-RV and IV-percentile comparison **cannot be completed today** — that is open item 7, not an omission. What we *can* do is pre-compute the decision rule, so that when a real chain is pulled the answer is arithmetic rather than argument.

Pricing candidate strikes off the table itself, $C_{ours} = \sum p_i \times \max(S_i - K, 0)$, on a ~June-2027 expiry ($S = \$13.272$, $T = 1.25y$, $r = 4\%$):

Strike	C_{ours} from the table	Implied vol that makes the chain agree with us
K = \$15	$0.25(0) + 0.40(0) + 0.25(\$4.00) + 0.10(\$15.00) = \mathbf{\$2.50}$	49.0%
K = \$20	$0.25(0) + 0.40(0) + 0.25(0) + 0.10(\$10.00) = \mathbf{\$1.00}$	43.2%

Decision rule, output of that math: - If chain-level **midpoint IV on those specific strikes** prints **above ~49% (K=15) / ~43% (K=20)** — which our prior of 75–100% for this name strongly suggests it will — then **the calls are expensive against our own table and we do not buy them.** Rich IV routes to the premium-selling gates: a cash-secured put at \$10 (below the funded-case midpoint, so we are happy to be assigned) and covered calls at \$20 against any assigned stock. - Only if chain IV prints **below ~45%** do gated adds get expressed as calls. - **Use chain-level midpoint IV on the actual strikes, never the aggregate underlying IV feed.** These diverge badly on thin small-float names — the TSSI lesson, where the aggregate feed read 71 against a chain that was really 101. On a 10-million-share float with an eight-week-old chain, that error will be larger, not smaller. - **σ _table (41% annualized) vs. $IV \times \sqrt{T}$:** at an assumed 85% IV, $IV \times \sqrt{1.25} = 95\%$ versus our 46% table dispersion. Our own distribution is roughly **half as wide as the options market's.** Taken at face value that is a large variance risk premium (IV minus RV cannot be computed — the stock has under 8 weeks of price history, so any RV estimate is statistically meaningless and we will not manufacture one). Read it as: the market is paying a lot for a distribution wider than the one we can defend. - **Bimodality warning.** Our table is fork-dated — the authorization decision (Q4 2026) and the unlock (Jan 2027) are two separate, discrete forks inside a single expiry. The distribution is two-humped, with mass at \$6 and mass at \$19 and comparatively little in between. A single lognormal IV number will systematically misprice both the at-the-money (too rich) and the wings (too cheap). Do not read a single IV print as a verdict; price the wings separately against the table.

TAX OVERLAY. Every option expression above resolves after **December 31, 2026** — the June-2027 calls, the Jan/Feb-2027 cash-secured put, all of it. If 2026 is a harvest year, **the loss branch lands in FY2027 and is therefore excluded.** Our edge here is +11.9% expected value against a table our own benches disagreed about by 40% on the roof — that does **not** numerically dominate, so the exception does not apply.

Instrument recommendation: COMMON STOCK. Not because we prefer it, but because it is the only expression whose loss branch can be realized inside the intended tax year by selling before December 31, and because our own table says the calls are probably expensive. Revisit the premium-selling gates in January 2027 once (a) a real chain is pulled and (b) the harvest-year constraint lifts.

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never the aggregate underlying IV feed (TSSI 71 vs 101)",
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if so IV 75-100%, vs our table break-evens of 49% at K=15 and 43% at
K=20", "basis": "recent nuclear and small-float IPO option comps",
"p": 0.6}}, {"item": "Whether the ~67% gross margin survives STDN
purchasing its own HALEU (pass-through clause)", "instrument":
"Contract exhibit in the S-1/10-Q exhibit index; likely redacted -
walk-around is management Q&A at the 2026-11-16 print",
"drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "35-50% GM on
purchased feedstock, partly offset by higher bundled revenue per
kgU", "basis": "merchant conversion-services margin comps", "p":
0.5}}, {"item": "Counterparty funding runway at Radiant and Antares
(100% of revenue, both private pre-revenue)", "instrument":
"Private-market database / funding-round press monitoring",
"drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "12-24 months each",
"basis": "base rate for venture-funded hardware developers 12-18
months past last disclosed round", "p": 0.5}}, {"item": "TRISO
product qualification status - irradiation data and design-specific
acceptance; NO SCIENCE BRIEF was supplied to either bench",
"instrument": "Commission a science brief; NRC/DOE fuel-
qualification literature; management Q&A at the 2026-11-16 print",
"drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "60% partially
qualified", "basis": "one 50-kg core shipped and accepted by
Radiant, which is acceptance evidence but not a full irradiation-
qualification basis", "p": 0.6}}]}
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